

Down, but not out: On the Border-Gavaskar Trophy

India lost a close series to Australia because of its batting **frailty**

A decade-long **dominance wound to a close** at the Sydney Cricket Ground on Sunday. The Border-Gavaskar **Trophy**, the second-biggest **silverware in terms of stature** after the **Ashes** in cricket, and the biggest on the basis of viewership, **has** been India's **preserve** since 2015. Australia last won the title in the 2014-15 home series and after that India **claimed** the trophy on four **occasions**. This winning **streak** ended once the fifth Test **concluded** at Sydney with Pat Cummins and his men winning by six wickets and **seizing** the series at 3-1. The **margin** could **hint at** a **vast** gap in ability between the two **squads**. But it was anything but that and India **had its moments** and could have finished on the **victor's podium**. This was a series where the batters **played second fiddle** to excellent **speedsters**. It is no surprise that when **Jasprit Bumrah**, the most dominant among them, **got** injured and could not bowl during the Australian second innings **chase** in the last Test, the host **prospered**. Bumrah began the series as captain, a position he returned to once the regular **skipper**, the out-of-form Rohit Sharma, opted out at the climax. And **Bumrah**, with 32 wickets, **led** the charts. Again with a **resilient** bat, he even helped India avoid the **follow-on** at Brisbane's Gabba.

A **transition** is upon the Indian Test unit, especially after failing to qualify for the ICC World Test Championship final. Having **eased out** Cheteshwar Pujara and Ajinkya Rahane and now **dealing with** R. Ashwin's retirement mid-series, the selectors and coach Gautam Gambhir need to look at the future of Virat Kohli, Rohit and Ravindra Jadeja. These players were India's core in Tests, but a change is **inevitable**. Tours **Down Under** often force a **flux**. Dilip Vengsarkar retired after the 1991-92 tour, Rahul Dravid and V.V.S. Laxman **followed suit** after their 2011-12 visit. In the current **sojourn**, despite scoring a **ton** in the first Test at Perth, Kohli's overall **yield** of 190 at 23.75 **was** poor. Rohit's numbers are even worse as he scored 3, 6, 10, 3 and 9. Yashasvi Jaiswal's runs, K.L. Rahul's initial consistency, **newcomer** Nitish Kumar Reddy's hundred at Melbourne, and the odd lower-order resistance, **bailed out** India but that was not enough. India lost due to batting **ineptitude**, a frailty that affected Australia too before its middle-order found a **second-wind** through Steve Smith, Travis Head and Marnus Labuschagne. Mohammed Siraj **toiled** hard but beyond him, Bumrah did not have much support from the bowling **ranks**. This was a series on which **Cummins**, through 25 wickets and 159 runs, **imposed** his **will**. India will need to find younger heroes, especially batters who are **adept at** playing both spin and pace, **at home** and abroad, in Tests and limited overs. [Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Down, but not out** (phrase) – Defeated or struggling but still capable of fighting back, not completely beaten पूरी तरह से पराजित न होना
2. **Frailty** (noun) – Weakness, vulnerability, flaw, deficiency, fragility कमजोरी
3. **Dominance** (noun) – Supremacy, control, ascendancy, power, superiority प्रभुत्व
4. **Wind to a close** (phrase) – Come to an end, conclude, finish, wrap up समापन की ओर जाना
5. **Silverware** (noun) – Trophy, cup, prize, award (in sports contexts) ट्रॉफी
6. **In terms of** (phrase) – With regard to, concerning, regarding, in relation to के संदर्भ में
7. **Stature** (noun) – Prestige, status, standing, reputation, prominence कद/महत्त्व
8. **Ashes** (noun) – In cricket, the prestigious Test series played between England and Australia एशेज (इंग्लैंड-ऑस्ट्रेलिया क्रिकेट श्रृंखला)
9. **Preserve** (noun) – Domain, area of dominance, stronghold, province अधिकार क्षेत्र
10. **Claim** (verb) – Win, secure, obtain, take, acquire जीतना
11. **Occasion** (noun) – Instance, event, time, moment अवसर
12. **Streak** (noun) – Run, series, sequence, succession सिलसिला
13. **Conclude** (verb) – End, finish, close, complete समाप्त करना
14. **Seize** (verb) – Take hold of, capture, snatch, grab, secure हथिया लेना
15. **Margin** (noun) – Difference, gap, amount, measure अंतर
16. **Hint** (at) (verb) – Indicate, suggest, imply, allude to संकेत देना
17. **Vast** (adjective) – Huge, immense, extensive, massive विशाल
18. **Squad** (noun) – Team, group, contingent, unit टीम
19. **Have one's moment** (phrase) – Enjoy brief success, gain temporary triumph, shine briefly अपना समय आना
20. **Victor** (noun) – Winner, conqueror, champion, top performer विजेता
21. **Podium** (noun) – Winners' stand, stage, rostrum, platform विजेता का मंच
22. **Play second fiddle** (phrase) – Take a subordinate role, be secondary, be

- overshadowed in importance दूसरे दर्जे पर रहना
23. **Speedster** (noun) – Fast bowler (in cricket), quick runner, swift athlete तेज गेंदबाज़
24. **Chase** (noun) – Pursuit (in cricket, the run target), hunt, race पीछा या लक्ष्य
25. **Prosper** (verb) – Succeed, flourish, thrive, do well सफलता पाना
26. **Skipper** (noun) – Captain, leader, head, chief कप्तान
27. **Resilient** (adjective) – Strong, tough, able to recover quickly, hardy, robust मज़बूत
28. **Follow-on** (noun) – In Test cricket, the second innings forced upon a team if they trail by a large margin अनिवार्य दूसरी पारी (क्रिकेट में)
29. **Transition** (noun) – Change, shift, transformation, evolution परिवर्तन
30. **Ease out** (phrasal verb) – Remove gradually, force out gently, make someone leave धीरे-धीरे बाहर करना
31. **Deal with** (phrasal verb) – Handle, manage, address, cope with निपटना
32. **Inevitable** (adjective) – Unavoidable, inescapable, certain, destined अनिवार्य
33. **Down Under** (noun) – Australia (colloquial), the Australian continent ऑस्ट्रेलिया
34. **Flux** (noun) – Uncertainty, instability, change, fluctuation परिवर्तनशीलता
35. **Follow suit** (phrase) – Imitate, do likewise, copy, take the same course वही करना
36. **Sojourn** (noun) – Stay, visit, temporary residence, brief period of living somewhere अल्पकालिक प्रवास
37. **Ton** (noun) – A hundred runs in cricket, century, major score (in cricket context) क्रिकेट में शतक
38. **Yield** (noun) – Output, return, result, produce परिणाम
39. **Newcomer** (adjective) – Fresh arrival, recently joined, inexperienced, new entrant नया
40. **Bail out** (phrasal verb) – Rescue, save, help, come to the aid बचाना
41. **Ineptitude** (noun) – Lack of skill, incompetence, clumsiness, inability अक्षमता
42. **Second-wind** (noun) – Renewed energy, revival, fresh impetus, resurgence नई ऊर्जा
43. **Toil** (verb) – Work hard, labour, strive, slog कड़ी मेहनत करना

44. **Impose** (verb) – Force, thrust, inflict, enforce थोपना

45. **Rank** (noun) – Position, level, standing, status श्रेणी/स्तर

46. **Will** (noun) – Determination, resolve, intent, desire इच्छाशक्ति

47. **Adept** (at) (adjective) – Skilled, proficient, expert, capable निपुण

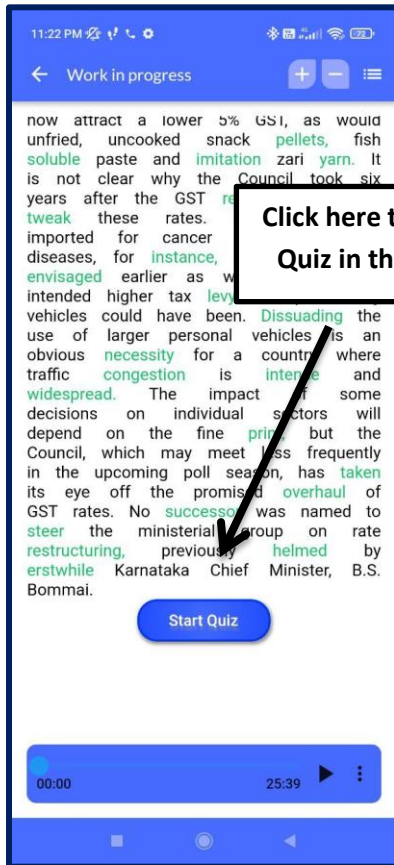
48. **At home** (phrase) – In one's own country/conditions, on familiar ground, comfortable in a familiar setting अपने घरेलू मैदान पर

@mocks_wallah

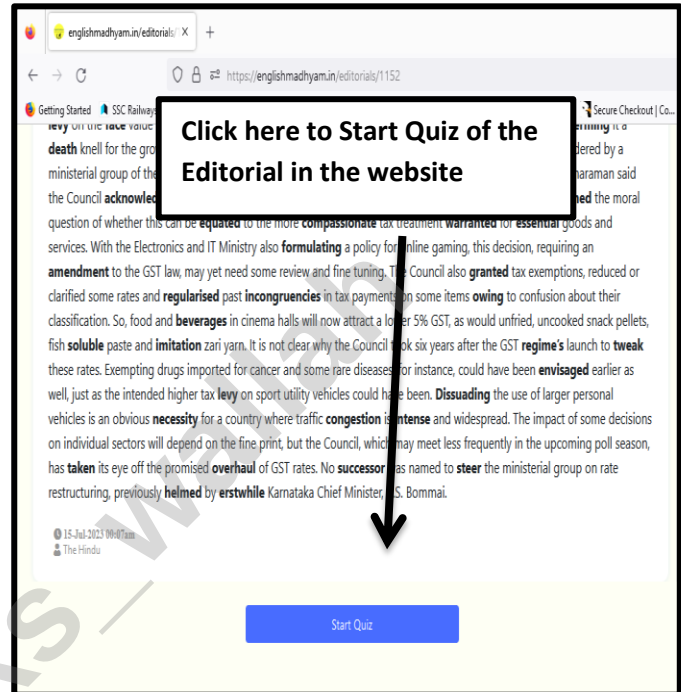
Summary of the Editorial

1. **End of India's Winning Streak:** India's dominance in the Border-Gavaskar Trophy since 2015 ended with Australia winning the series 3-1.
2. **Series Significance:** The Border-Gavaskar Trophy, second in stature after the Ashes and a global viewership phenomenon, saw a hard-fought contest.
3. **Competitive Margin:** Despite the series scoreline, the gap between the teams was not vast, and India had its moments to seize victory.
4. **Bowling Over Batting:** The series was dominated by excellent pace bowling, with Jasprit Bumrah leading the charts with 32 wickets.
5. **Bumrah's Impact:** Bumrah, also the stand-in captain, played a pivotal role with the ball and bat, but his injury in the final Test affected India's chances.
6. **Rohit Sharma's Struggles:** Regular captain Rohit Sharma opted out of the final Test due to form issues, marking a disappointing performance throughout the series.
7. **Transition in Indian Cricket:** The team faces a transitional phase, with senior players like Virat Kohli, Rohit Sharma, and Ravindra Jadeja nearing potential exits.
8. **Mid-series Retirement:** R. Ashwin retired mid-series, adding to the challenges faced by India's Test unit.
9. **Past Patterns of Change:** Historical parallels show that tours to Australia often precipitate retirements and team transitions.
10. **Batting Woes:** India's primary weakness was its fragile batting, with subpar performances from senior players like Kohli and Rohit.
11. **Emerging Performers:** Yashasvi Jaiswal, K.L. Rahul, and newcomer Nitish Kumar Reddy showed promise but could not consistently lift the team.
12. **Australian Middle-order Resurgence:** Australia's middle-order, led by Steve Smith, Travis Head, and Marnus Labuschagne, found form to secure victories.
13. **Bowling Limitations:** Mohammed Siraj worked tirelessly, but the bowling attack lacked depth beyond Bumrah's contributions.
14. **Cummins' Dominance:** Australian captain Pat Cummins excelled, taking 25 wickets and contributing 159 runs, shaping the series outcome.
15. **Future Outlook for India:** India must identify younger batters adept at playing spin and pace, both at home and abroad, to rebuild for Tests and limited-overs cricket.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



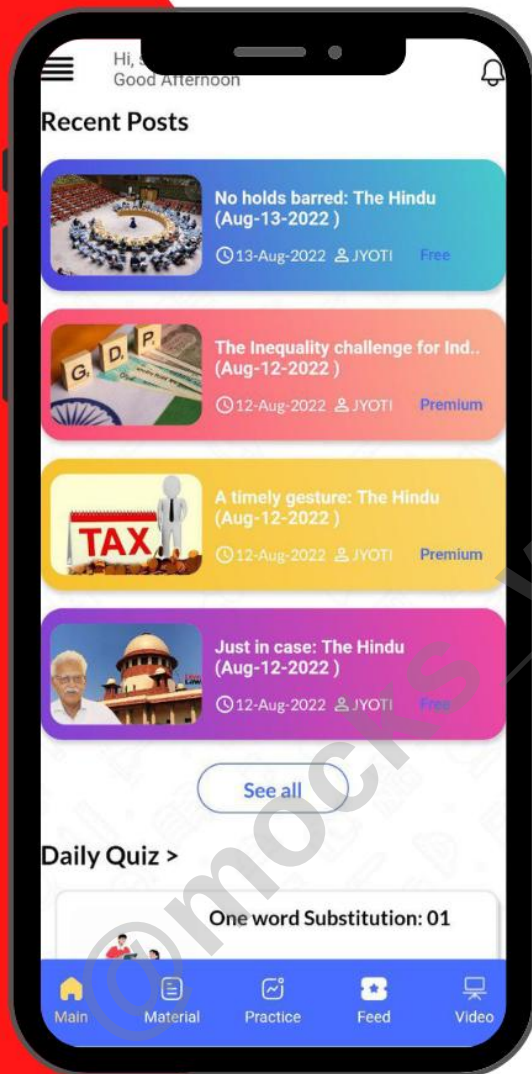
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